

In spite of containing such valuable and sensitive data, few users give thought to backing up their data, and fewer still do it in a comprehensive way. A survey by security company Avast revealed that less than half of smartphone users regularly backup their phones, yet more than 80% are concerned about losing precious data. Given the high stakes, it's pragmatic to have a robust backup system set-up on your smartphone, one that has your data protected in the event of any eventuality. This chapter has you covered - we'll show you multiple ways of backup up your Android, iOS, Windows or Blackberry smartphone.

I. Android

Android is easily the most widely used smartphone Operating System in the world - according to most reports, about 70% - 80% of the world's smartphones run some version of Android. Luckily, Android's open nature enables a whole host of options with regards to backing up your data - from simply using apps to backup your SMS and photos, to using the recovery mode to create a full system backup of everything on your smartphone. The latter is more complicated and requires an unlocked bootloader, but we'll walk you through the process in a later section. While the title of the chapter may say smartphone, these backup systems are equally applicable to tablets running Android.

1. Google Backup

Nearly all Android phones come with a full suite of Google apps installed, including Google Play Services - which enables, among other things, access to the Google Play Store. When you sign in to your Gmail account on your phone, Google automatically backs up a few important settings and data, and you can choose to restore data from this backup should you sign in to another Android device (or if you perform a factory reset of your device). To make sure this is enabled, go to Settings > Backup and Reset and check the box for "Backup my data". Some of the things that Google backs up to your Gmail account are:

a. Contacts

Contacts are probably the most important data on one's phone, so it's important that you turn on Google Contact Sync (Head over to Settings > Accounts > Google and check the box next to Contacts). When you enable contact sync, Google syncs all of your contact information into the cloud, where